OUTREACH PLAYBOOK · 2026

LINKEDIN OUTREACH

How to turn Premium into actual conversations — who to message, exactly what to write, and what to do when they reply.

Prepared for	Plan	Companion	Date
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01 Using Premium properly

Most people pay for Premium and use none of it. These are the parts that pay for themselves.

FEATURE	WORTH IT?	HOW TO ACTUALLY USE IT
InMail credits	Yes — this is the main one	Message people you are not connected to. Keep it under 900 characters.
Who viewed your profile	Yes	Expanded to 90 days. Someone who viewed you is a warm lead — reply within 48 hours.
Advanced search filters	Yes	Seniority, function, company size, years of experience. This is how you build a real list.
Applicant insights	Only when applying	Shows how you compare to other applicants. Does not get you the job — use it to pick battles.
Salary insights	Sometimes	Useful when a recruiter asks for a number before you have scope.
LinkedIn Learning	Optional	Only if a specific role asks for a specific skill you lack.
Premium badge	Neutral	Nobody hired anyone for the badge. Ignore it.

BEFORE YOU SEND ANYTHING

Ninety percent of outreach fails because the profile does not survive the click. Fix these five first — full detail is in `LinkedIn-Playbook.pdf`:

1. **Headline** — proof-led, not a job title
2. **About first three lines** — outcome, then evidence
3. **Featured** — all 7 projects with live links and thumbnails
4. **Custom button** — "Visit portfolio" → pf.mtkcodex.site
5. **Services** — five focused services, no SEO or Android filler

People check the profile before they reply. If the message is good and the profile is empty, you lose the reply anyway.

02 Who to message

Ten researched messages beat a hundred templated ones. Build a list of twenty.

Four search recipes

TARGET	SEARCH	WHY THEY BUY
Small SaaS founders	Title: Founder OR CEO · Industry: Software Development · Company size: 11–50	They need a second build, a rewrite, or a feature their team cannot ship
Agency owners	Title: Owner OR Managing Director · Industry: Marketing & Advertising	They sell work they cannot deliver — CRM, portals, client dashboards
Hiring managers	Search *Posts* → "hiring [your role]" → filter Past week	They posted the need publicly, which means it is real and urgent
Job posters	Jobs tab → open a role → the poster is listed under "Posted by"	Messaging the poster beats applying into the void

Signals worth acting on

- They posted a job for something you have shipped before
- They announced funding, a launch, or a new market
- They are complaining publicly about spreadsheets, manual work, or a broken process
- They just hired a Head of Operations — systems work usually follows
- They viewed your profile (check the last 90 days in Premium)

THE BEST FIRST MESSAGE IS NOT A PITCH

It is proof that you looked. One specific detail about their product, their post, or their job listing is worth more than three paragraphs about you.

Build the list in one sitting

1. Open a sheet with: name, company, role, URL, signal, channel, date, status, next action
2. Add 20 people using the recipes above
3. Write one line per person explaining why *them* specifically
4. If you cannot write that line, remove them — you will send a bad message
5. Template is ready at `linkedin-assets/outreach-tracker.csv`

03 Connection notes

300 characters. No pitch. The only goal is the accept.

A · FOUNDER, PRODUCT-SPECIFIC

Hi [Name] — I build multi-tenant SaaS platforms (7 shipped, 3 live). Saw [Company] is scaling [specific thing]; happy to share how we handled [specific problem] without adding headcount. Worth connecting?

B · HIRING MANAGER

Hi [Name] — saw you're hiring a [role]. I've shipped 7 production platforms on Next.js and TypeScript, end to end. Happy to send the three questions I'd ask every candidate for that role. Worth connecting?

C · VIA A SHARED CONNECTION

Hi [Name] — [Mutual] suggested I reach out. I build SaaS platforms end to end (7 shipped, 3 live). Not pitching anything — I'd just like to stay connected in case [topic] comes up on your side.

D · AFTER THEIR POST

Hi [Name] — your post on [topic] was the clearest take I've read on it. I've been dealing with the same problem at [Company]. Would like to follow what you ship next.

E · NO CONTEXT, KEEP IT LIGHT

Hi [Name] — I work on multi-tenant SaaS and AI workflows out of Lahore. Your work on [thing] caught my eye. Happy to connect and swap notes on [topic].

RULE	WHY
Never mention "opportunities"	It reads as a job request and gets declined
One specific detail	It is the only thing proving this is not a blast
No links	Links in a first message look like spam
End with a question	Questions get accepted and answered more than statements

VOLUME

Send 20–25 a week, not 100. LinkedIn limits invitations and flags accounts that behave like a mail merge. Quality is also simply faster.

04 InMail

For people you cannot connect with. Shorter than you think.

InMail is a paid message to someone outside your network. It arrives with a subject line and gets one shot — there is no thread to recover in. Keep it under 900 characters, make one ask, and skip everything that sounds like a brochure. The shape is: proof you looked → proof you built → one small ask → a clean exit.

CLIENT · SUBJECT: "YOUR [PRODUCT] + [SPECIFIC FEATURE]"

Hi [Name],

You added [specific feature] to [Product] last month — that's the part I'd have built first too.

I build multi-tenant SaaS platforms end to end: 7 shipped, 3 live, 500+ tenants. The closest thing to your setup was [project], where [one concrete result].

I'm not asking for a project. I'd like 15 minutes to show you two things I'd change in [specific area] — you keep the ideas either way.

Does Thursday or Friday work better?

— Kashif

HIRING MANAGER · SUBJECT: "[ROLE] — SHIPPED 7 PLATFORMS, 3 LIVE"

Hi [Name],

Saw the [role] post. Rather than send a CV cold, one thing that might be useful: I've shipped 7 production platforms (Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL), three of them live with real tenants today.

For a role like yours the relevant part is probably [specific requirement from their post] — I did exactly that at [project], where [result].

If it's still open, I'd welcome 15 minutes. If it's filled, I'd still like to know what the team is building.

— Kashif

PARTNERSHIP · SUBJECT: "IDEA FOR [COMPANY] + [PARTNER]"

Hi [Name],

You and [Partner] serve the same customer from different angles — [observation].

I build the systems in the middle: multi-tenant SaaS, integrations, AI workflows. I've done this for [comparable situation].

Worth a short call to see if there's something real here? If not, I'll leave you alone.

— Kashif

05 The follow-up sequence

Most replies come from the second and third touch. Most people stop after the first.

WHEN	WHAT YOU SEND	GOAL
Day 0	Connection note or InMail	Get the accept or the read
Day 1–2	Thanks + context, no ask	Become a person, not a request
Day 4	One specific observation about their product	Give value before asking for anything
Day 9	The actual ask — 15 minutes	Convert interest into a conversation
Day 16	Clean close-out	Leave the door open, stop the chase

DAY 1–2 · AFTER THEY ACCEPT

Thanks for connecting, [Name]. Quick context so I'm not a stranger in your feed: I build multi-tenant SaaS platforms — 7 shipped, 3 live in production. Currently working on [thing] at [Company].

No ask. Just thought [specific thing about them] was worth following.

DAY 4 · THE VALUE DROP

[Name] — I was on [Product] this morning and noticed [specific observation]. If you're already aware, ignore me. If not, it's probably costing [specific cost] on [specific flow].

Happy to send the one-page write-up I made for a similar case — no charge.

DAY 9 · THE ASK

[Name] — I'll be direct since you're busy: I have room for one build next month, and [Company] is the kind of problem I'd want to work on.

Fifteen minutes to see if there's a fit? If the timing is wrong, tell me and I'll check back in [quarter].

DAY 16 · CLOSE-OUT

[Name] — I'll stop here so I'm not cluttering your inbox. If [specific thing] becomes a priority later, I'm easy to find.

Good luck with [specific thing they're doing].

THREE FOLLOW-UPS, THEN STOP

Silence is usually timing, not rejection. Chasing past three messages costs you the relationship and the referral that might have come from it.

06 The job track

Same principles, different audience. Recruiters skim the spec; hiring managers decide on what ships.

To a recruiter

SUBJECT: "[ROLE] — 7 PLATFORMS SHIPPED, 3 LIVE"

Hi [Name],

I applied for [role] on [date] and wanted to put a face to the application.

Short version: 7 production SaaS platforms shipped, 3 live with real tenants, full stack from PostgreSQL schema to deployment. The closest match to your spec is [project] — [one result].

Happy to answer anything the CV doesn't cover.

— Kashif

To the hiring manager directly

SUBJECT: "ONE QUESTION ABOUT [ROLE]"

Hi [Name],

You're hiring a [role]. I'll skip the pitch and ask the question I'd want answered if I were you: is the priority shipping [specific thing] in the next quarter, or stabilising what already exists?

I've done both — most recently [example with a number]. If the first one is the answer, we should talk.

— Kashif

Asking for a referral

SUBJECT: "QUICK FAVOUR — [COMPANY] [ROLE]"

Hi [Name],

You're at [Company] and they're hiring a [role]. I'm not going to ask you to vouch for me blind.

If you're open to it, I'll send you a three-line summary and my CV — you can forward it or ignore it with no hard feelings.

Either way, good to be connected.

07 When they reply

The reply is not the win. The next step is.

THEY SAY	YOU SAY
"Send your CV"	Sent — plus a one-page case study of the closest thing I've built for you: [link]. If it's useful, I can walk through the architecture in 15 minutes.
"What's your rate?"	Most builds like this land between [X] and [Y] depending on scope. I can send a fixed-scope quote after a 15-minute call — that way you're not comparing guesses.
"We're not hiring now"	Understood. I'll check back in [quarter]. In the meantime, here's a short teardown of one thing I noticed in [product] — no charge, no strings.
"We already have a team"	Makes sense. Teams usually get stuck on [specific thing] rather than general capacity. If that becomes the bottleneck, I do short engagements for exactly that.
"Too expensive"	Fair. What range are you working with? I'll tell you honestly what's realistic at that number instead of quietly shrinking the scope.
"Let me think about it"	Of course. I'll follow up on [specific date]. If it's easier, here's the one-pager so you have the details when you need them.
No reply at all	Move to the close-out message on day 16. Do not send a fourth follow-up.

Four rules for every reply

1. **Reply within 24 hours** — speed is read as reliability
2. **Never argue** — a polite "that makes sense" beats being right
3. **Always end with a next step or a clean exit** — never leave it hanging
4. **Never discount reflexively** — change scope, not price

TURN EVERY CONVERSATION INTO EVIDENCE

After each call, ask: "Would you be open to a two-line note about what we discussed? It helps people like you decide whether I'm worth fifteen minutes." That is how the recommendation count on your profile goes up without begging.

08 Rules, tracking, first week

The boring parts that keep your account healthy and your pipeline honest.

Etiquette and account safety

- **Personalise line one.** If it could be sent to anyone, do not send it.
- **Under 900 characters.** Long messages read as effort you made for yourself, not them.
- **No links in the first message.** Save them for when they ask.
- **20–25 invitations a week.** Near the limit looks automated.
- **No automation tools or bots.** This is the fastest way to get restricted.
- **One follow-up per thread per week.** More than that is pestering.
- **Reply within 24 hours** when they respond — including "no".

Track it or it did not happen

Use `linkedin-assets/outreach-tracker.csv` — open it in Excel or Google Sheets. Columns: name, company, role, URL, signal, channel, first message date, status, next action date, notes, outcome.

Review it every Friday. Anyone with no reply after three touches moves to *dormant* and gets revisited next quarter. That is not failure — that is a list that keeps working.

Your first week

DAY	ACTION	TIME
Mon	Profile pass — headline, About, Featured, button, services	45 min
Tue	Build the list of 20 with one reason each	40 min
Wed	Send 10 connection notes + 3 InMails	30 min
Thu	Follow up with everyone who accepted	20 min
Fri	Value drops, review the tracker, request one recommendation	30 min

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE AFTER 30 DAYS

Twenty real conversations, three to five calls, one or two proposals — and a profile that answers the question before anyone asks it. That is a working pipeline, not luck.